

ID: SOMA-C-P01

Title: Environmental Survey

Duration: 10m 00s (706 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you are ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore the practice of an Environmental Survey.

You can sit, stand, or lie down. Maintain a sharp focus throughout the session.

If you are sitting, make sure your legs are uncrossed. Place your feet flat on the floor to establish a stable baseline. If you need to adjust your posture during this task, do so immediately. Check that your spine is straight. Make whatever practical adjustments to ensure your body is securely positioned.

[Short Pause] (10s - Settling in)

Take a normal breath now. Direct your gaze forward. Keep your eyes open as you prepare for an ordered visual survey.

Begin to conduct a visual inventory of the room. Move your eyes to identify specific colors, distinct shapes, and solid objects.

Estimate the relative size of the furniture around you. Note the exact distance between yourself and the nearest wall. Look for right angles. Check where the walls meet the ceiling and the floor.

Trace the geometric lines in the room. Follow the vertical edges of the doors, windows, or large furniture. Check whether they appear parallel to one another. Count the total number of corners visible from your current vantage point. One, two, three. Assess the overall layout of the space.

Your goal is to categorize what you see. Organize the items into logical groups. You might sort objects by their practical function or tally items by their primary color. Identify each category and then immediately move to the next section of the room.

[Long Pause] (30s - Visual cataloging)

Now, shift your attention to evaluating physical weight distribution. Direct your focus to identify the structural contact points supporting your body.

Find the exact spot where your weight pushes down the hardest on the floor or your chair. In your mind, name the materials around you. Ask yourself if your seat is made of wood, metal, or another material.

Calculate if your physical weight is distributed symmetrically, or if it is shifted.

Note the exact placement of your hands. Identify the specific material they are currently in contact with. Next, evaluate the position of your feet on the ground. Compare the two points of contact. Estimate the current ambient temperature of the room in degrees. Verify if the

structural support is stronger on the left side of your body or the right side.

Take the next few moments to complete this structural analysis. Build a mental checklist of the primary load-bearing points. Conduct this evaluation efficiently. Organize these spatial details clearly in your mind.

[Long Pause] (30s - Structural inventory)

Shift your focus to the sounds around you. Direct your mind to pick out the different noises in the room.

What background sounds are currently active? Try to find more than one source of noise if there are several happening at once.

Sort these sounds by how loud they are: which ones are louder and which are softer? Organize them by how far away they seem: are they close to you or further out in the distance?

Identify where the sound is coming from—is it on your left, your right, or directly behind you? Focus on whether the noise is a steady hum or if it follows a specific rhythm. Mentally check off every sound source you find as if you are completing a list.

If the environment is quiet, estimate the duration of the silence in seconds. Or classify the current state as: "Zero audio detected."

[Long Pause] (30s - Acoustic analysis)

And now, direct your attention to the room's ventilation. Can you determine the direction of the airflow? Test the air quality in your immediate vicinity. Is the air circulating well, or does the space seem enclosed? If you cannot detect any drafts, that is a valid data point. Simply record that absence in your mental checklist.

[Short Pause] (10s - Airflow analysis)

Next, do a quick temperature check of the room. You might notice the floor is cooler, while the air near the ceiling is warmer. The goal is to measure your space quickly. Guess the exact temperature of the room in degrees, or rate it on a scale from 1 to 10.

[Short Pause] (10s - Thermal estimation)

[Short Pause] (10s - Transition to close)

We will now end this practice. Do one last check of your physical position. Are you sitting, standing, or lying down? Take one or two breaths to mark the end of this exercise.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Now bring this analysis to a close.

Thank you for your practice.

Footer: License: Licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike). This material is part of the SOMA Architecture and is free for non-commercial research use; any adaptations must be shared under identical terms. **How to Cite:** For the most current citation, DOI, and project updates, please visit the SOMA OSF Repository (<https://osf.io/2kfvz>). **Version 1.0 (March 2026)** – Practice P01: Environmental Survey.